

Seniors United Now

The Voice of Seniors in Alberta

September 04, 2024

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To: Danielle Smith - Alberta Premier
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David Lardner - PSPP Board of Directors and C.E.O
Nathan Neudorf - Minister of Affordability and Utilities
Naheed Nenshi - Leader of the Official Opposition

Subject: Cost of Living is U.C.P's Top Priority

Alberta Seniors United Now (SUN) is a non-profit, non-partisan organization established in 2003 to enable all seniors in Alberta to contribute and truly participate in the well-being of the Province of Alberta. We provide a venue for discussion and united action on the needs, concerns and challenges that effect all Alberta Seniors.

We are encouraged when we read the June 12, 2024 Edmonton Journal article written by the Hon. Nathan Neudorf, Minister of Affordability and Utilities. He states, "Addressing the cost of living is a top priority for the UCP Government". To see the results of the Affordability Action Plan is quite an accomplishment which included protecting and supporting vulnerable Albertans, including Seniors and indexing financial benefits like AISH and other Social Programs.

Your Affordability Action plan will assist many Albertans in maintaining their livelihood during these inflationary times.

SUN has recently conducted a review of Cost-of-Living Adjustment Standards that relate to a number of pension plans. The results indicate that the Local Authority Pension Plan provides 100% COLA to their retirees as well as the Canada Pension Plan. Reviewing the proposed legislation for the proposed Alberta Pension Plan also confirms that 100% of COLA would also be provided.

Unfortunately, the Public Service Pension Plan for many decades only provides 60% COLA to their retirees, while at this point in time the plan currently has a surplus of 4.54 billion-dollar surplus. Because of this deficiency over many decades these retirees have seen their livelihood diminish to the point of creating undue hardship. These Public Service employees (now retirees) worked under many different Governments during their working years, such as Social Credit, Conservative, N.D.P. and the current U.C.P. They were the ones that greased the wheels of Government that helped make Alberta the Province that it is today.

We do know that the Public Service Pension Plan retirees are questioning, why would the proposed Alberta Pension Plan provide 100% COLA and the PSPP only provides 60%. It is a good question and it needs to be addressed.

We are requesting an opportunity to meet with you to discuss the importance of providing 100% COLA for the Public Service Pension Plan retired members.

We are looking forward to meeting with you at your convenience in the very near future.

Sincerely,

Wayne Sorenson

Wayne Sorenson
President – Seniors United Now

